

William A. Blanco

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EDUCATION

University of San Diego

M.S. in Cybersecurity Engineering (Combined)

San Diego, CA
Expected: May 2027

University of San Diego

B.A. in Computer Science Concentration in Cybersecurity

San Diego, CA
Expected: August 2026

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Java, Python, C++,
Swift

Tools & Platforms: Github, Xcode, Linux, VS
Code, Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit

Networking & Security: TCP/IP, DNS & DHCP,
SIEM, Log Analysis

Frameworks & Technologies: SwiftUI, Firebase

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ - In Progress

PROJECTS

SpeciesID - iOS Species Identification App (Swift, CoreML, Firebase, Python/PyTorch)

4-person team project - responsible for authentication and UI

- Implemented Firebase Authentication in Swift, integrating Google Sign-In and email/password login flows into a production ready iOS app.
- Built and styled the login and authentication UI views in SwiftUI, handling auth state transitions and session persistence across app launches.
- Collaborated with teammates integrating CoreML-based species classification, Firebase backend, and a PyTorch training pipeline.

Home Lab SIEM with AI-assisted Incident Response - Personal Project | April 2026

- Built an isolated VirtualBox lab environment and deployed Splunk Enterprise with Universal Forwarder to ingest and index logs from an Ubuntu Server target machine.
- Authored SPL detection rules identifying SSH brute-force and port scan attacks in real time, with automated alerts and severity classification.
- Developed a Python script integrating Splunk's REST API with an AI API to auto-generate structured incident reports from raw security alerts.
- Validated detection coverage through controlled penetration testing with Nmap and Metasploit, simulating real-world attack scenarios

EXPERIENCE

Motor Transport Non-Commissioned Officer, United States Marine Corps

Camp Pendleton, CA | 2017-2021

- Led and mentored a team of 20+ personnel in vehicle operations, safety procedures, and technical training across multiple equipment platforms.
- Tracked and reported fleet inventory and asset readiness using enterprise logistics software (GCSS), maintaining accurate records through full maintenance lifecycles.
- Troubleshoot and resolved mechanical and communication system failures in high-pressure environments, minimizing downtime and ensuring operational availability.